

STATEMENT OF WORK

Employee Leave Management & Approval Portal (ELAP)

Field	Detail
Document ID	SOW-ELAP-001
Version	1.0
Status	Draft — Pending Stakeholder Sign-Off
Source Document	BRD-ELAP-001, Version 1.0
Prepared By	Sameer Rathod — Project Manager
Business Analyst	Soham Ahirrao
Project Sponsor / Client	Prof. Mr. Sayantan
Institution	ITM Skills University — Project Management Course
Planned Delivery	September 30, 2026

Prepared for Client / Stakeholder Review and Sign-Off

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Executive Summary

The client currently manages employee leave through email and Microsoft Excel. The BRD identifies fragmented records, approval delays of approximately 3–5 business days, limited HR visibility across eight departments, manual reconciliation, and absence of a complete audit trail.

ELAP is a centralized web application replacing this manual process. Employees submit requests through the portal; requests follow a mandatory Reporting Manager → HR approval chain; HR receives organization-wide visibility; and status transitions are recorded for auditability.

1. Document Control

Field	Detail
Project	Employee Leave Management & Approval Portal (ELAP)
SOW ID / Version	SOW-ELAP-001 / 1.0
Source BRD	BRD-ELAP-001 Version 1.0
BRD Status	Draft — Pending Stakeholder Sign-Off
Prepared By	Sameer Rathod — Project Manager
Prepared Date	August 29, 2026
Client / Sponsor	Prof. Mr. Sayantan
Planned Delivery	September 30, 2026

Baseline Relationship

This SOW translates the business requirements in BRD-ELAP-001 into a delivery and commercial baseline. The BRD remains the detailed requirements reference. Any material deviation from the BRD or this SOW must follow the change-control process.

2. Project Background & Business Need

Business Problem	Expected Delivery Response
Fragmented email / Excel records	Centralized portal as the single source of truth.
3–5 business day approval delays	Structured workflow, dashboards and reminders/escalation where delivered.
No HR visibility	HR dashboard covering all eight departments.
No audit trail	Immutable logging of status transitions, actor, action and timestamp.
Manual balance tracking	System-managed CL / SL / EL balance display and enforcement.
Scattered discussions	Per-request portal comments where P1 functionality is delivered.

3. Objectives & Success Measures

Objective	Target / Measure
Eliminate Excel-based leave tracking	100% of leave requests via portal; 0 active Excel trackers within 2 weeks of go-live.
Reduce processing time	From 3-5 business days toward ≤48 hours.
Complete HR visibility	All eight departments visible with real-time status.
Auditable leave trail	Every status change logged with timestamp, actor and action.
Reduce HR reconciliation effort	70% reduction target, measurable within 30 days of go-live.
Low learning curve	First leave request completable without training in ≤3 clicks.

4. Business Process & Workflow

To-Be process: Employee logs in → submits leave → system validates balance/routing → Reporting Manager reviews → Manager approves or rejects → if approved, request routes to HR → HR gives final approval/rejection → employee receives status → audit trail is updated throughout.

Step	Actor	System / Business Outcome
1	Employee	Submit request; status becomes PENDING_MANAGER.
2	Manager	Approve → PENDING_HR; Reject → REJECTED_BY_MANAGER and flow ends.
3	HR	Approve → APPROVED; Reject → REJECTED_BY_HR.
4	Employee	Track status and cancel before HR final approval where permitted.
5	System	Record every status transition in audit trail.
6	System / P1	Send notifications and apply reminder/escalation rules where P1 is delivered.

5. Functional Requirements Summary

BRD IDs	Capability	SOW Commitment / Priority
FR-01-02	Authentication & RBAC	Employee/Manager/HR authentication and role boundaries. P0
FR-03	Employee Profile	Employee identity, department, manager and joining date. P0
FR-04-06	Leave Creation / Routing	Create request, display/enforce balance, route to manager. P0
FR-07-08	Attachments / Email	Optional attachments and Resend notifications / secure action links. P1
FR-09-13	Manager / HR Workflow	Dashboards, approve/reject, two-tier routing and final HR decision. P0
FR-14-16	Status / Notification / History	Real-time status, decision notification, role-scoped history. P0/P1
FR-17-19	Structure / Comments / Audit	Eight departments, comments, immutable audit trail. P0/P1/P0
FR-20-23	Search / Reports / Reminder / Escalation	Search/filter/sort, CSV, 48h reminder, 72h escalation. P1
FR-24-25	Cancellation / Responsive	Cancel before HR approval; desktop/tablet/mobile web. P0

6. Non-Functional Requirements

ID	Category	Requirement
NFR-01	Security	RBAC enforced at API and UI level.
NFR-02	Security	Passwords hashed; sessions expire after 30 minutes idle.
NFR-03	Security	Email action links signed, 72-hour expiry, portal login required.
NFR-04	Reliability	Requests/decisions must not be lost; transactional DB handling.
NFR-05	Auditability	Critical actions logged immutably.
NFR-06	Performance	Dashboard target load time within 3 seconds.
NFR-07	Scalability	Departments/employees can be added without code changes.
NFR-08	Usability	Leave submission target ≤3 clicks.
NFR-09	Responsive	Desktop, tablet and mobile.
NFR-10	Maintainability	Modular architecture suitable for future HR modules.
NFR-11	Availability	Target ≥99% uptime during business hours.
NFR-12	Data Privacy	Employee data accessible only to authorized roles.

7. Business Rules & Leave Model

Rule	Requirement	Priority
BR-01	Portal is the single source of truth; email is notification / quick action only.	P0
BR-02	Two-tier approval is mandatory: Manager + HR.	P0
BR-03	Manager rejection is final; it does not reach HR.	P0
BR-04	Manager and HR must provide a comment when rejecting.	P0*
BR-05-08	Balance enforced; future dates; no overlaps; cancellation before HR approval.	P0
BR-09-10	48h reminder and 72h HR escalation.	P1
BR-11-12	One department/manager per employee; medical certificate for SL ≥3 days.	P0/P1

* Rejection comments are mandatory in FR-10/BR-04; one BRD table labels them P1. This SOW treats the explicit business rule as stronger and flags priority for confirmation.

Leave Balance Model

Type	Annual	Carry Forward	Encashment	Key Rule
CL	12 days	No	No	Max 3 consecutive days per instance.
SL	12 days	No	No	Medical certificate if ≥3 consecutive days (P1).
EL	15 days	Yes, max 30	Yes, on separation	Apply ≥3 days in advance; accrued 1.25 days/month.

Available Balance = Opening Balance – (Approved Leaves + Pending Leaves). Balance is displayed before submission and deducted only upon final HR approval.

8. Technology & Delivery Environment

Layer	BRD Baseline
Application	Next.js 14+ App Router; TypeScript; Tailwind CSS; shadcn/ui.
Database	PostgreSQL via Supabase or Neon; Prisma ORM.
Authentication	NextAuth.js / Auth.js v5; credential login; JWT sessions.
Email	Resend; free tier noted as 100 emails/day.
File Storage	Uploadthing or Cloudinary.
Hosting	Vercel free tier; CDN / SSL / auto-deploy.
Scheduled Jobs	Vercel Cron for P1 reminder/escalation.
Version Control	GitHub: main → develop → feature branches.
Agile Management	Jira for backlog, Scrum/Kanban, sprint planning and tracking.

9. Timeline & Sprint Plan

Phase / Sprint	Dates	Goal	Key Deliverables	Owners
PHASE 1 / Sprint 0	Aug 29-Sep 5	Discovery + Setup	BRD baseline; repo; Vercel/DB; Prisma; Jira; charter.	All team
PHASE 1 / Sprint 1	Sep 6-Sep 12	Auth + Data Foundation	Login/RBAC; employee/departments; 8 departments; profile; navigation.	Atharva; Antriksh
PHASE 1 / Sprint 2	Sep 13-Sep 19	Leave + Approval	Leave form/balance; routing; manager dashboard; decisions; HR approval; cancellation.	Atharva; Soham
PHASE 1 / Sprint 3	Sep 20-Sep 26	HR Dashboard + P1	HR dashboard/history; email; attachments; comments; search/filter; CSV; reminder/escalation.	Atharva; Antriksh
PHASE 1 / Sprint 4	Sep 27-Sep 30	Testing + UAT + Go-Live	E2E/responsive testing; fixes; polish; UAT; deployment; closure.	All team
PHASE 2 / Future Scope	After Phase 1	Future HR Expansion	Attendance/time tracking; auto-accrual; payroll integration; mobile; SSO/AD; analytics; performance; recruitment/onboarding; multilingual; delegation.	Separate approval

Schedule Control: If behind at any Sprint Review, P1 is cut first to protect the September 30 deadline and P0 baseline.

Sprint Ceremonies

Ceremony	Cadence	Duration	Format
Daily Stand-up	Daily	5 min	WhatsApp: Did / Doing / Blocked
Sprint Planning	Monday of each sprint	20 min	Google Meet / in-person
Sprint Review	Last day of sprint	20 min	Demo
Retrospective	Last day of sprint	10 min	WhatsApp / Notion

10. Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Name	Responsibilities
Project Sponsor / Client	Prof. Mr. Sayantan	Business sponsorship, clarification, UAT and final sign-off.
Project Manager	Sameer Rathod	Scope, schedule, delivery, stakeholders, risks and change control.
Business Analyst	Soham Ahirrao	Requirements, acceptance criteria, UAT scripts, testing and clarifications.
Solution Architect	Antriksh Manwadkar	Architecture, technical decisions and security.
Tech Lead	Atharva Gahine	Implementation, code quality, defect fixes and deployment.
Scrum Master	Sanchita Suryawanshi	Sprint process, ceremonies and blocker removal.
Employees	Simulated end users	Submit leave and track status.
Reporting Managers	Simulated approvers	Tier 1 review and approval/rejection.
HR	Simulated system owner	Tier 2 approval and organization-wide monitoring.

11. Testing, UAT & Definition of Done

Test Type	Approach	Owner	When
Functional	Manual testing against acceptance criteria.	Soham	Sprints 2-4
RBAC	Verify each role's access boundaries.	Soham	Sprints 1-3
Workflow	Submit → Manager approve → HR approve end-to-end.	Soham	Sprints 2-3
Responsive	Desktop, tablet and mobile.	Soham	Every sprint
Email	Verify Resend delivery/action flow.	Atharva	Sprint 3
Edge Cases	Overlap, insufficient balance, cancellation, escalation.	Soham	Sprints 3-4
UAT	Sponsor tests key scenarios on staging.	Prof. Sayantan + Soham	Sprint 4

Definition of Done

- Functional requirement is met according to the BRD.
- Acceptance criteria pass.
- Responsive behavior and RBAC are verified; audit trail logs correctly; no critical bugs remain; feature is deployed to Vercel.

12. Acceptance Criteria / Go-No-Go

ID	Acceptance Condition	Verification
AC-01	Employee can log in and submit a leave request.	UAT
AC-02	Leave balance is displayed and enforced correctly.	Data verification
AC-03	Request routes to correct reporting manager.	Multi-department UAT
AC-04	Manager can approve/reject with comments.	UAT
AC-05	Manager-approved request routes to HR.	UAT
AC-06	HR can approve/reject; employee is notified where notification is delivered.	UAT
AC-07	HR dashboard shows all eight departments with filters.	Dashboard demo
AC-08	Balance is deducted only on final HR approval.	Data verification
AC-09	Audit trail exists for every status change.	Audit review
AC-10	Portal is responsive on mobile.	Device testing
AC-11	Leave management can operate without Excel/email as the primary management system.	Stakeholder confirmation

UAT & Sign-Off Sequence

1) BA prepares UAT scripts → 2) PM schedules UAT → 3) Sponsor and BA test on staging → 4) Tech Lead fixes defects → 5) BA re-tests → 6) Sponsor provides formal sign-off.

13. Assumptions & Dependencies

Assumption	Risk if Invalid
Modern browser and internet access.	Affected users cannot access portal.
Resend free tier sufficient.	Notifications may be limited.
Standalone email/password auth; no SSO.	Additional authentication work required.
Eight departments as defined in BRD.	Department setup must be revised.
CL=12, SL=12, EL=15 unless Sponsor changes.	Balance model changes.
No payroll/ERP/HRMS API integration in Phase 1.	Integration scope/time increases.
One reporting manager per employee.	Matrix reporting needs redesign.
Vercel + Supabase/Neon free tiers sufficient.	Paid infrastructure may be required.
Sponsor available for final-week UAT/sign-off.	Acceptance/go-live may slip.
GitHub accessible to all team members.	Development workflow may be disrupted.

13. Dependencies

ID	Dependency	Owner	Impact if Delayed
D-01	Department names confirmed or assumptions accepted.	Soham → Prof. Sayantan	Blocks Sprint 1 seeding.
D-02	Resend account setup.	Atharva	Blocks email module.
D-03	Supabase/Neon account setup.	Atharva	Blocks DB work.
D-04	GitHub repository creation.	Atharva	Blocks development.
D-05	Vercel project setup.	Atharva	Blocks deployment.
D-06	Leave entitlements confirmed or standard model accepted.	Soham → Prof. Sayantan	Blocks balance model.

14. Risk Management

ID	Risk	Prob.	Impact	Mitigation
R-01	Scope creep	High	High	PM gates changes; log for Phase 2/change control.
R-02	Two-tier workflow edge cases	Medium	High	Defined rules and edge-case testing.
R-03	Email action links blocked by spam	Medium	Medium	Portal is primary; email is convenience.
R-04	Email link spoofing	Medium	High	JWT-signed links, 72h expiry, portal login.
R-05	Team capacity vs 5-week timeline	High	High	Protect P0; cut P1 early if behind.
R-06	Free-tier limits exceeded	Low	Medium	Monitor usage and scale if needed.
R-07	Fixed Sep 30 deadline	High	High	Weekly reviews; cut P1 if behind.
R-08	Sponsor unavailable for clarification	Medium	Medium	Batch questions and document assumptions.
R-09	Team member unavailability	High	Medium	Front-load critical work; Sprint 4 buffer.
R-10	DB schema changes mid-development	Medium	Low	Controlled Prisma migrations.

15. Change Control

The approved SOW and BRD form the delivery baseline. A change request is required for new requirements, material modifications, new integrations, material timeline changes, or out-of-scope features.

- PM records and assesses the change; BA assesses business impact; SA/Tech Lead assess technical, security and effort impact.
- PM communicates scope, schedule, effort and dependency impact.
- The change is approved, rejected, deferred to Phase 2, or incorporated with stakeholder agreement.
- Unapproved scope changes are not part of the committed Phase 1 deliverables.

16. Budget & Commercial Note

The BRD states a hypothetical budget of ₹1,00,000 and estimated actual technology cost of approximately ₹500-₹3,000, largely using free-tier services. This SOW creates no commercial payment obligation unless separately agreed and signed.

Cost Item	Estimate	Note
Vercel	₹0	Free tier
Supabase / Neon	₹0	Free tier
Resend	₹0	Free tier; 100 emails/day
Uploadthing / Cloudinary	₹0	Free tier
GitHub	₹0	Free
Optional Domain	₹500-₹1,000	Vercel .vercel.app URL available
Miscellaneous	₹500-₹2,000	Documentation / minor tools
Actual Estimated Total	₹500-₹3,000	BRD estimate
Hypothetical Budget	₹1,00,000	Explicitly hypothetical

17. Deliverables & Project Closure

- ELAP responsive web application deployed to the agreed Vercel environment.
- Employee, Manager and HR authentication/RBAC; leave request, balance, approval, status, cancellation, history and audit capabilities in P0 scope.
- Manager and HR dashboards; P1 features completed where time/capacity permits.
- Testing/UAT evidence, final deployment and project closure report.

Closure is reached after UAT, resolution or acceptance of critical defects, final deployment and formal Project Sponsor sign-off.

18. Open Items / Clarifications Before Final Sign-Off

#	Item	Recommended Treatment
1	BRD says “5 weeks / 5 sprints”; detailed plan is Sprint 0-4 with 4/7/7/7/8-day durations.	Use exact dates shown; confirm Sprint 0 counting convention.
2	Rejection comments are mandatory but one scope table labels them P1.	Treat as required business behavior; confirm priority.
3	Attachments are P1 but appear in workflow.	Confirm optional P1, not P0 go-live dependency.
4	₹1,00,000 is hypothetical; actual estimate ₹500-₹3,000.	Confirm academic/hypothetical vs commercial treatment.
5	Department names and leave entitlements are assumptions.	Confirm before Sprint 1 seeding / balance finalization.

19. Sign-Off & Approval

By signing below, the stakeholder confirms that the Phase 1 scope, delivery approach, responsibilities, timeline, acceptance approach and stated assumptions are understood and approved as the baseline for delivery, subject to the open items being resolved or explicitly accepted.

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Project Sponsor / Client	Prof. Mr. Sayantan		
Project Manager	Sameer Rathod		

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Business Analyst	Soham Ahirrao		
Solution Architect	Antriksh Manwadkar		
Tech Lead	Atharva Gahine		
Scrum Master	Sanchita Suryawanshi		

Reference Baseline: BRD-ELAP-001 Version 1.0, prepared by Soham Ahirrao, Business Analyst, August 29, 2026. This SOW should be read together with the detailed BRD.